

CARVAKA (CĀRVĀKA / LOKĀYATA)

SOURCE-CRITICAL ENTRY → EPISTEMIC GATE → INFERENCE CONTROVERSY → MATERIAL ONTOLOGY → TRANSCENDENT DENIALS → ETHICS WITHOUT CARICATURE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g14 repaired in place; prior artifacts unchanged outside the scoped current generation

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 SOURCE-CRITICAL ENTRY

SOURCE-CRITICAL ENTRY RECONSTRUCTION BEFORE DOCTRINE LOST BRĤASPATI-SŪTRA OPPONENT REPORTS QUOTED FRAGMENTS (MĀDHAVA, JAYANTA, (OFTEN POLEMICAL) DISTINGUISH ATTESTED THESIS FROM HOSTILE CARICATURE THIS-WORLDLY ORIENTATION; CĀRVĀKA MATERIALIST SCHOOL LABEL

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- CARVĀKA / LOKĀYATA: RECONSTRUCTION BEFORE DOCTRINE lost Brĥaspati-sūtra opponent reports quoted fragments
- (Mādhava, Jayanta, (often polemic)

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- RULE: distinguish attested thesis from hostile caricature
- Lokāyata = this-worldly orientation; Cārvāka = materialist school label.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- CARVĀKA / LOKĀYATA: RECONSTRUCTION BEFORE DOCTRINE lost Brĥaspati-sūtra opponent reports quoted fragments
- (Mādhava, Jayanta, (often polemic)

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cārvāka is recoverable only through source-critical reconstruction: hostile testimony must be qualified, but convergent reports still establish a stable materialist core.

01

STAGE 01 EPISTEMIC GATE

EPISTEMIC GATE VALID KNOWLEDGE (PRAMĀ) REJECTED INDEPENDENT SOURCES PERCEPTION (PRATYAKṢA) PERCEPTION INFERENCE (ANUMĀNA) VERBAL TESTIMONY (ŚABDA) COMPARISON (UPAMĀNA) DIRECT, SENSE-GROUNDED INFERENCE TESTIMONY COMPARISON OBSERVED SMOKE IS INVARIABLY FIRE-LINKED.

PERCEPTION (pratyakṣa) / PERCEPTION inference (anumāna) verbal testimony

(śabda) comparison (upamāna) direct, sense-grounded inference testimony comparison observed conjunction is finite

universal invariable concomitance (vyāpti) outruns perception smoke seen with fire in kitchens != smoke is

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- VALID KNOWLEDGE (PRAMĀ) REJECTED INDEPENDENT SOURCES
- PERCEPTION (pratyakṣa) / PERCEPTION inference (anumāna) verbal testimony

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- (śabda) comparison (upamāna) direct, sense-grounded inference testimony comparison observed conjunction is finite
- universal invariable concomitance (vyāpti) outruns perception smoke seen with fire in kitchens != smoke is invariably fire-linked.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VALID KNOWLEDGE (PRAMĀ) REJECTED INDEPENDENT SOURCES
- PERCEPTION (pratyakṣa) / PERCEPTION inference (anumāna) verbal testimony

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) epistemology treats perception (pratyakṣa) as the only independent means of valid knowledge (pramāna), while accepting inference only as fallible practical expectation rather than certain knowledge.

02

STAGE 02 INFERENCE CONTROVERSY

INFERENCE CONTROVERSY CĀRVĀKA ATTACK INFERENCE NEEDS UNIVERSAL CONCOMITANCE (VYĀPTI) INVARIABLE CONCOMITANCE (VYĀPTI) KNOWN BY PERCEPTION INCOMPLETE SURVEY HIDDEN CONDITION (UPĀDHI) MAY DEFEAT THE RULE FIRE WITHOUT SMOKE, WET FUEL MATTERS NYĀYA REPLY REPEATED AGREEMENT + ABSENCE OF COUNTER-INSTANCE + HYPOTHETICAL REASONING

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- CĀRVĀKA ATTACK: inference needs universal concomitance (vyāpti) invariable concomitance (vyapti) known by inference → circularity
- by perception → incomplete survey hidden condition (upādhi) may defeat the rule: fire without smoke, wet fuel matters

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- NYĀYA REPLY: repeated agreement + absence of counter-instance + hypothetical reasoning (tarka) agreement in presence (anvaya) (presence) +
- agreement in absence (vyatireka) (absence) → defeasible but rational invariable concomitance (vyāpti)

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- CĀRVĀKA COUNTER-PRESSURE: practical expectation may work without certainty
- SELF-REFUTATION CHARGE: arguing against inference already employs inference.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cārvāka attacks inference by arguing that finite observation cannot establish universal concomitance and may always conceal a defeating condition.

03

STAGE 03 MATERIAL ONTOLOGY

MATERIAL ONTOLOGY ONLY THIS-WORLDLY ELEMENTS ARE REQUIRED EARTH + WATER + ORGANISED LIVING BODY CONSCIOUSNESS CONSCIOUSNESS IS A BODY-PROPERTY, NOT AN IMMATERIAL SUBSTANCE FERMENTATION INGREDIENTS INTOXICATING POWER NOT PRESENT SEPARATELY LIVING CONSCIOUS BODY (DEHĀTMA-VĀDA) DEATH ELEMENTAL DISSOLUTION

consciousness is a body-property, not an immaterial substance analogy: fermentation ingredients → intoxicating power not

ONLY THIS-WORLDLY ELEMENTS ARE REQUIRED earth + water + fire + air → organised living

SELF = living conscious body (dehātma-vāda) death → elemental dissolution → no surviving enduring self

QUALIFICATION: emergence is asserted; a full mechanism is not supplied.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- ONLY THIS-WORLDLY ELEMENTS ARE REQUIRED earth + water + fire + air → organised living body → consciousness
- consciousness is a body-property, not an immaterial substance analogy: fermentation ingredients → intoxicating power not present separately

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- SELF = living conscious body (dehātma-vāda) death → elemental dissolution → no surviving enduring self (ātman), rebirth or afterlife
- QUALIFICATION: emergence is asserted; a full mechanism is not supplied.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- ONLY THIS-WORLDLY ELEMENTS ARE REQUIRED earth + water + fire + air → organised living body → consciousness
- consciousness is a body-property, not an immaterial substance analogy: fermentation ingredients → intoxicating power not present separately

MECHANISM / VERDICT — QUALIFICATION: emergence is asserted; a full mechanism is not supplied.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cārvāka explains consciousness as an emergent property of organised matter, though it offers an analogy of emergence rather than a developed causal mechanism.

04

STAGE 04 TRANSCENDENT DENIALS

TRANSCENDENT DENIALS NO PERCEPTUAL WARRANT NO IMMORTAL SOUL NO REBIRTH NO ACTION AND MORAL CONSEQUENCE (KARMA) AS SUPERSENSIBLE MORAL NO HEAVEN/HELL NO POST-MORTEM REWARD OR PUNISHMENT NO CREATOR GOD

NO PERCEPTUAL WARRANT

no immortal soul → no rebirth

no action and moral consequence (karma) as supersensible moral force

no heaven/hell → no post-mortem reward or punishment

no creator God → world needs no transcendent planner

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- NO PERCEPTUAL WARRANT
- no immortal soul → no rebirth
- no action and moral consequence (karma) as supersensible moral force

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- no heaven/hell → no post-mortem reward or punishment
- no creator God → world needs no transcendent planner
- no Vedic infallibility → priestly testimony lacks intrinsic authority

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- RESULT: metaphysics is cut back to perceptible nature and embodied life.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RESULT: metaphysics is cut back to perceptible nature and embodied life.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Once perception is the sole independent warrant, soul, creator, rebirth and unseen ritual efficacy lose their claimed epistemic foundation.

05

STAGE 05 ETHICS WITHOUT CARICATURE

ETHICS WITHOUT CARICATURE PURUṢĀRTHA FILTER DHARMA REJECTED WHEN GROUNDED IN UNSEEN REWARD OR VEDIC COMMAND REJECTED AS LIBERATION OF A SEPARABLE SOUL MATERIAL WELL-BEING INTELLIGIBLE GOODS WITHIN ONE EMBODIED LIFE PRUDENT ENJOYMENT RECKLESS INDULGENCE PLEASURE SOUGHT WEIGH PAIN, SOCIAL CONSEQUENCE AND ATTAINABLE MEANS EXAM CONTROL

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE
PURUṢĀRTHA FILTER dharma: rejected when grounded in unseen reward or Vedic command liberation (mokṣa): rejected as liberation of
a separable soul material well-being (artha) + pleasure (kāma): intelligible goods within one embodied life prudent enjoyment !=

DECISIVE DISTINCTION
reckless indulgence pleasure sought → weigh pain, social consequence and attainable means
EXAM CONTROL: call it naturalistic hedonism or this-worldliness

EVALUATION / TRAP
do not reduce the school to the hostile slogan "eat, drink and borrow."
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• PURUṢĀRTHA FILTER dharma: rejected when grounded in unseen reward or Vedic command liberation (mokṣa): rejected as liberation of

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) ethics is best read as prudent this-worldly well-being rather than crude hedonism: pleasure is valuable, pain is a cost, and action requires intelligent calculation within embodied social life.

06

STAGE 06 COMPARATIVE PRESSURE MAP

COMPARATIVE PRESSURE MAP ISSUE CĀRVĀKA NYĀYA BUDDHISM MEANS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE (PRAMĀNA) (PRAMĀNAS) PERCEPTION + INFERENCE SELF CONSCIOUS BODY ENDURING ENDURING ANTI-DOGMATIC EVIDENTIAL DISCIPLINE PERCEPTION-ONLY RULE STRUGGLES TO JUSTIFY SCIENCE, MEMORY AND ITS

DOCTRINE / CLAIM
ISSUE CĀRVĀKA NYĀYA BUDDHISM means of valid knowledge (pramāna) perception only four means of valid knowledge
(pramānas) perception + inference self conscious body enduring enduring self (ātman) anātman stream causation observed sequence realist relation

OBJECTION / PRESSURE
dependent origination transcendent denied God, soul, action and moral consequence (karma) action and moral consequence (karma) without creator
liberation death ends person release (apavarga) cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvāna)

REPLY / RESIDUAL
STRENGTH: anti-dogmatic evidential discipline
LIMIT: perception-only rule struggles to justify science, memory and its own critique.

DOCTRINE / CLAIM
• ISSUE CĀRVĀKA NYĀYA BUDDHISM means of valid knowledge (pramāna) perception only four means of valid knowledge
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OBJECTION / PRESSURE
• dependent origination transcendent denied God, soul, action and moral consequence (karma) action and moral consequence (karma) without creator
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REPLY / RESIDUAL
• STRENGTH: anti-dogmatic evidential discipline
• LIMIT: perception-only rule struggles to justify science, memory and its own critique.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — LIMIT: perception-only rule struggles to justify science, memory and its own critique.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cārvāka's evidential discipline exposes dogmatism, yet its perception-only criterion is narrower than the reasoning required to defend that discipline.

07

STAGE 07 PYQ ANSWER RAIL

PYQ ANSWER RAIL DEFINE SOURCE PROBLEM STATE PERCEPTION THESIS RECONSTRUCT INFERENCE ATTACK EXPLAIN HIDDEN LIMITING CONDITION (UPĀDHI)/CIRCULARITY GIVE NYĀYA REPLY ASSESS SELF-REFUTATION DERIVE MATERIALISM EMBODIED SELF TRANSCENDENT DENIALS

DEFINE source problem → STATE perception thesis → RECONSTRUCT inference attack explain hidden limiting condition

Nyāya reply → assess self-refutation derive materialism → embodied self → transcendent denials → ethical

QUALIFIED VERDICT: Cārvāka is a rigorous empiricist challenge, but its exclusive perception (pratyakṣa) criterion is

reasoning needed to defend that challenge.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- DEFINE source problem → STATE perception thesis → RECONSTRUCT inference attack explain hidden limiting condition (upādhi)/circularity → give
- Nyāya reply → assess self-refutation derive materialism → embodied self → transcendent denials → ethical result

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- QUALIFIED VERDICT: Cārvāka is a rigorous empiricist challenge, but its exclusive perception (pratyakṣa) criterion is narrower than the
- reasoning needed to defend that challenge.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- DEFINE source problem → STATE perception thesis → RECONSTRUCT inference attack explain hidden limiting condition (upādhi)/circularity → give
- Nyāya reply → assess self-refutation derive materialism → embodied self → transcendent denials → ethical result

MECHANISM / VERDICT — QUALIFIED VERDICT: Cārvāka is a rigorous empiricist challenge, but its exclusive perception (pratyakṣa) criterion is narrower than the reasoning needed to defend that challenge.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cārvāka is a rigorous empiricist challenge, but its exclusive perception (pratyakṣa) criterion is narrower than the reasoning needed to defend that challenge.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT 1. HISTORICAL RECONSTRUCTION AND THE SOURCE PROBLEM 2. EPISTEMOLOGY — PERCEPTION AS THE SOLE MEANS OF 3. THE CRITIQUE OF INFERENCE — INVARIABLE CONCOMITANCE (VYĀPTI) 4. THE NYĀYA DEFENCE OF INFERENCE — AND A 5. METAPHYSICS AND MATERIALISM — FOUR BHŪTAS, THE 6. SELF, BODY AND CONSCIOUSNESS — CONSCIOUS BODY AS 7. THE REJECTION OF TRANSCENDENT ENTITIES — GOD, SOUL

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- 1. Historical Reconstruction and the Source Problem
- 2. Epistemology — Perception as the Sole Means of valid knowledge (pramāna)
- 3. The Critique of Inference — Invariable concomitance (vyāpti), Hidden limiting condition (upādhi), the Socrates Syllogism and Self-Refutation
- 4. The Nyāya Defence of Inference — and a Critically Balanced Verdict

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- 5. Metaphysics and Materialism — Four Bhūtas, the Rejection of Ākāśa, and Explanation through natural properties (svabhāva-vāda)
- 6. Self, Body and Consciousness — Conscious body as self (dehātma-vāda), and Cārvāka versus Buddhist Anātman (2024, 20 marks)
- 7. The Rejection of Transcendent Entities — God, Soul, Action and moral consequence (karma), Rebirth, Heaven, Liberation (mokṣa), Veda and Ritual
- 8. Ethics and the Political-Social Meaning — and Cārvāka versus Jaina Reality (2020, 15 marks)

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- 9. Comparative Synthesis and Answer-Writing Architecture
- A genuine early principle of epistemic economy: do not multiply unseen entities without warrant.
- A real and still powerful problem about the warrant for universals and invariable concomitance (vyāpti).
- A valuable naturalistic check on speculative metaphysics, ritualism, and unverifiable claims.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.